

7-Day China Trip Plan

Beijing - Shanghai - Chengdu

By ChinaTripBox.com

[OK] Day 1-2: Beijing \-- Great Wall, Forbidden City, Hutong food tour

[OK] Day 3-4: Shanghai \-- The Bund, French Concession, Huangpu River

[OK] Day 5-7: Chengdu \-- Pandas, Hotpot, Leshan Giant Buddha

[OK] Transport between cities (high-speed rail)

[OK] Hotel recommendations by budget

[OK] Daily budget estimates

Before You Go

This 7-day plan covers the three essential China experiences: the capital's history (Beijing), the financial hub's energy (Shanghai), and Sichuan culture with pandas (Chengdu). The route is connected by high-speed rail, so you'll spend travel time in the 2-4 hour range between cities.

Getting Between Cities

Beijing to Shanghai: High-speed rail, 4.5 hours, CNY550 (\$75) second class. Book via 12306 app or Trip.com.

Shanghai to Chengdu: Flight, 3 hours, from CNY600 (\$85). Or high-speed rail, 11 hours, CNY700 (\$100).

Day 1-2: Beijing

Where to Stay

Dongcheng District (near Forbidden City) or Xicheng District (near Houhai). Budget: CNY400-800/night mid-range. Use DiDi or metro to get around.

Day 1: The Classics

- Morning: Tiananmen Square + Forbidden City (book tickets 7 days ahead online, 60 RMB).
- Lunch: Wangfujing Snack Street. Try Beijing zhajiangmian (noodles) and lamb skewers.
- Afternoon: Jingshan Park for the best Forbidden City panorama. Free or 2 RMB.
- Evening: Wangfujing Night Market or a hutong food tour.

Day 2: Great Wall

- Option A (popular): Mutianyu Great Wall. 2-hour bus from Dongzhimen. Cable car up, toboggan down. 45 RMB entry.
- Option B (less crowded): Jinshanling. 3-hour drive. Better for hiking. 65 RMB.
- Tip: Bring water, snacks, and cash. The wall has limited shops.
- Evening: Beijing roast duck at Sijimin Fang (Dongsi). ~120 RMB per person.

Day 3-4: Shanghai

Where to Stay

The Bund area for first-timers, French Concession for a quieter vibe. Mid-range: CNY500-900/night.

Day 3: Arrival + The Bund

- Morning: Take 4.5h high-speed train from Beijing South to Shanghai Hongqiao.
- Lunch: Local xiaolongbao (soup dumplings) at Din Tai Fung or a local shop.
- Afternoon: Walk the Bund (free). Cross to Lujiazui for the skyline view.
- Evening: Huangpu River night cruise. 120-180 RMB. Best at 7pm when the lights come on.

Day 4: Old & New Shanghai

- Morning: Yu Garden + City God Temple. 30 RMB. Go early to avoid crowds.
- Lunch: Local noodles at a French Concession shop.
- Afternoon: Walk the French Concession. Wukang Road is the most beautiful street.
- Evening: Bars on The Bund or Xintiandi. Cocktails 60-100 RMB.

Day 5-7: Chengdu

Where to Stay

Jinjiang District (near Chunxi Road) or near the Panda Base for an early start. CNY300-600/night.

Day 5: Pandas + Hotpot

- Morning: Chengdu Research Base of Giant Panda Breeding. Go by 8am (pandas are most active). 55 RMB. Takes 2-3 hours.
- Lunch: Mapo Tofu at Chen Mapo Tofu (a Chengdu institution). ~50 RMB.
- Evening: Hotpot at a local spot. Go for the 'yuanyang' (half-spicy, half-mild) pot if you can't handle Sichuan spice. ~80-150 RMB per person.

Day 6: Leshan Day Trip

- Morning: 1-hour bus or train to Leshan. The Giant Buddha is a UNESCO site. 80 RMB.
- Afternoon: Walk the plank stairs from top to bottom. Takes 2 hours.
- Evening: Back in Chengdu. Try Chengdu street food: dan dan noodles, chuan chuan, rabbit head (if you're adventurous).

Day 7: Chill + Depart

- Morning: Jinli Ancient Street (free) or Wuhou Shrine (60 RMB).
- Lunch: Final Sichuan meal.
- Afternoon: Head to Chengdu Tianfu Airport (CTU) or Chengdu Shuangliu (CTU old).

Budget Summary

Expense	Budget (per day)	Mid (per day)
Accommodation	CNY200-CNY400	CNY400-CNY800
Food	CNY80-CNY150	CNY150-CNY300
Transport	CNY50-CNY100	CNY100-CNY200
Activities	CNY50-CNY120	CNY120-CNY250
Total/day	CNY380-CNY770	CNY770-CNY1550